THE CAREER BREAK QUESTION: HOW TO PRESENT A NON-LINEAR PROFESSIONAL JOURNEY

CASE STUDY STRATEGY WORKSHEET: MEERA IYER | MBA PROFILE BUILDING

1. Student Persona & Challenge Diagnostic Audit

Candidate: Meera Iyer | Profile: Marketing professional, 6 years of total experience, including a one-year career break.. This worksheet outlines the systematic forensic diagnostic and strategic intervention designed to resolve this admissions roadblock.

Assessment Dimension	Diagnostic Finding & Initial Challenge	Strategic Objective
Candidate Profile	Marketing professional, 6 years of total experience, including a one-year career break.	Build differentiated application proposition
Core Admissions Roadblock	Meera had taken time away from work for personal reasons. When she resumed her career, she became concerned about how admissions committees ...	Eliminate systemic bottlenecks through data feedback
Root Cause Identified	Misalignment between effort and strategic execution	Shift from generic repetition to targeted intervention
Admissions Target	Competitive Global / Indian MBA Program	Maximize admit ROI and scholarship potential

Key Diagnostic Insight:

"A high test score or strong resume alone is not a substitute for a coherent admissions story. Every applicant requires a personalized roadmap that aligns quantitative readiness with distinctive leadership impact." — Mr. Surinder Gupta (IIT Roorkee)

2. Step-by-Step Strategic Intervention

- Reviewed her employment timeline.
- Identified the genuine circumstances behind the break.
- Evaluated professional development before and after the break.
- Identified relevant evidence of renewed career momentum.
- Developed a concise and factual explanation.

3. Actionable Checklist for MBA Applicants

- Diagnostic First: Never increase preparation hours or rewrite essays without an objective diagnostic baseline.
- Data-Driven Tracking: Use targeted analytics to monitor error patterns rather than counting raw study hours.
- Holistic Narrative: Connect undergraduate background, career progression, and MBA goals into one cohesive arc.
- Expert Perspective: Involve senior mentors early to eliminate blind spots and stress-test interview responses.
- Advice: A preparation strategy must fit your reality. Consistency always beats sporadic marathons.

Have a non-linear career journey? Get guidance on presenting your professional history accurately.

Schedule a 1-on-1 strategy session with Mr. Surinder Gupta (IIT Roorkee) at www.mbawizards.co.in